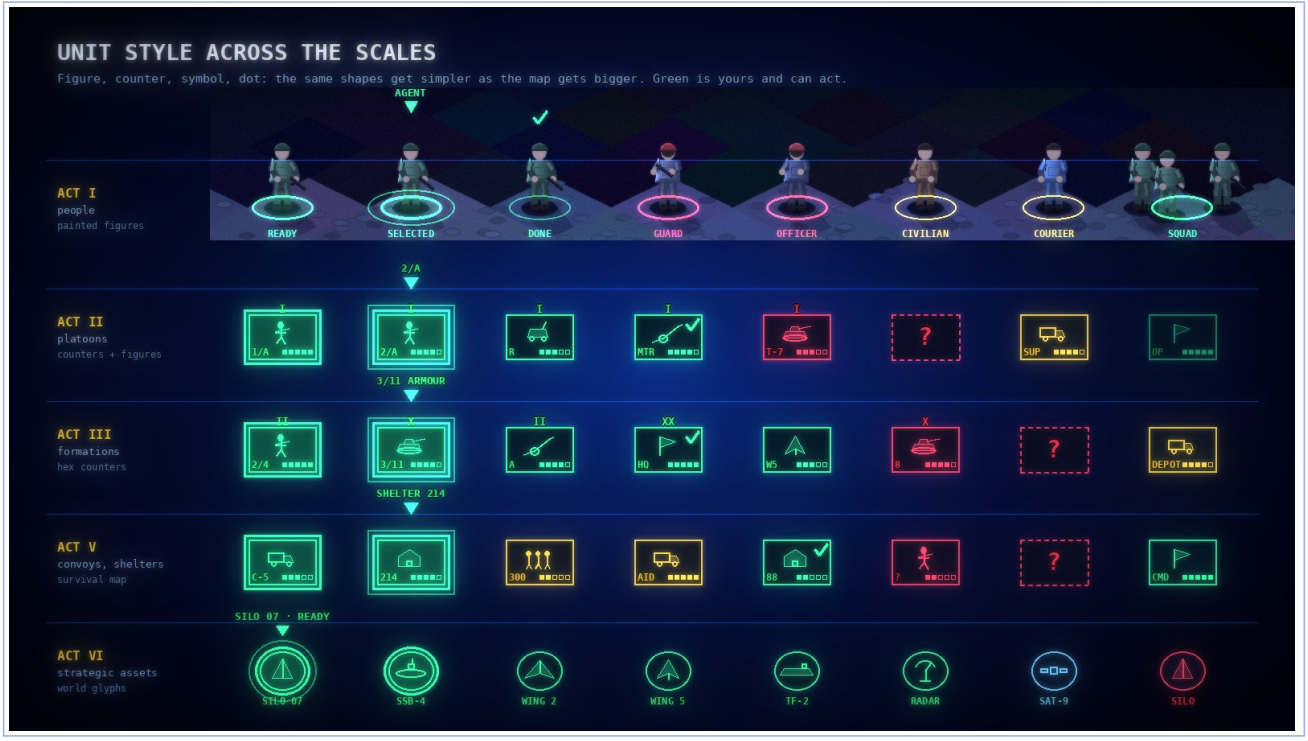
Look and units across all scales

Draft 2: refined figures and scale rules, the large maps with their units, and one unit style sheet for every scale.

Summary. The figures now have volume (a lit side and a shaded side, a rim light, jointed limbs and a soft contact shadow) and sit at a fixed real-world scale against buildings, doors and vehicles. The unit style is one family across the whole game: **figure, counter, symbol, dot**, getting simpler as the map gets bigger. Green always means yours and able to act, with a ring or frame for ready units and a double ring plus flag for the selected one. All samples are procedurally drawn mock-ups, not engine footage.

Scale rules (these are locked early; the art on top can keep changing)

Thing	Rule	Why it matters for play
One tile	1.5 m on the close maps	Movement, cover and range are counted in tiles
A person	1.75 m, about 1.2 tiles tall	Figures read as human against doors and windows; no figure is bigger without a reason
A door / a floor	2.1 m / 3.0 m (two tiles of height)	Heights, ladders and roofs are consistent, so sight and cover can be trusted
A car / a container	4.5 m / 6 m long	Cover and blocking sizes
Size that carries meaning	Vehicles and heavy units are larger; people are not	A VIP or officer is not bigger, but is marked with a flag or ring
Counters on maps	Same size within a map; strength shown in five pips	The map stays readable and never turns into a pile of different shapes



Unit style sheet. Painted figures for Acts I and II, counters on terrain and hex maps with a symbol, an echelon mark and five strength pips, convoys, shelters and refugees for the survival map, and round glyphs for strategic assets. Green is yours and can act; red is opposing; yellow is objective or neutral; a dashed '?' is an unseen contact.



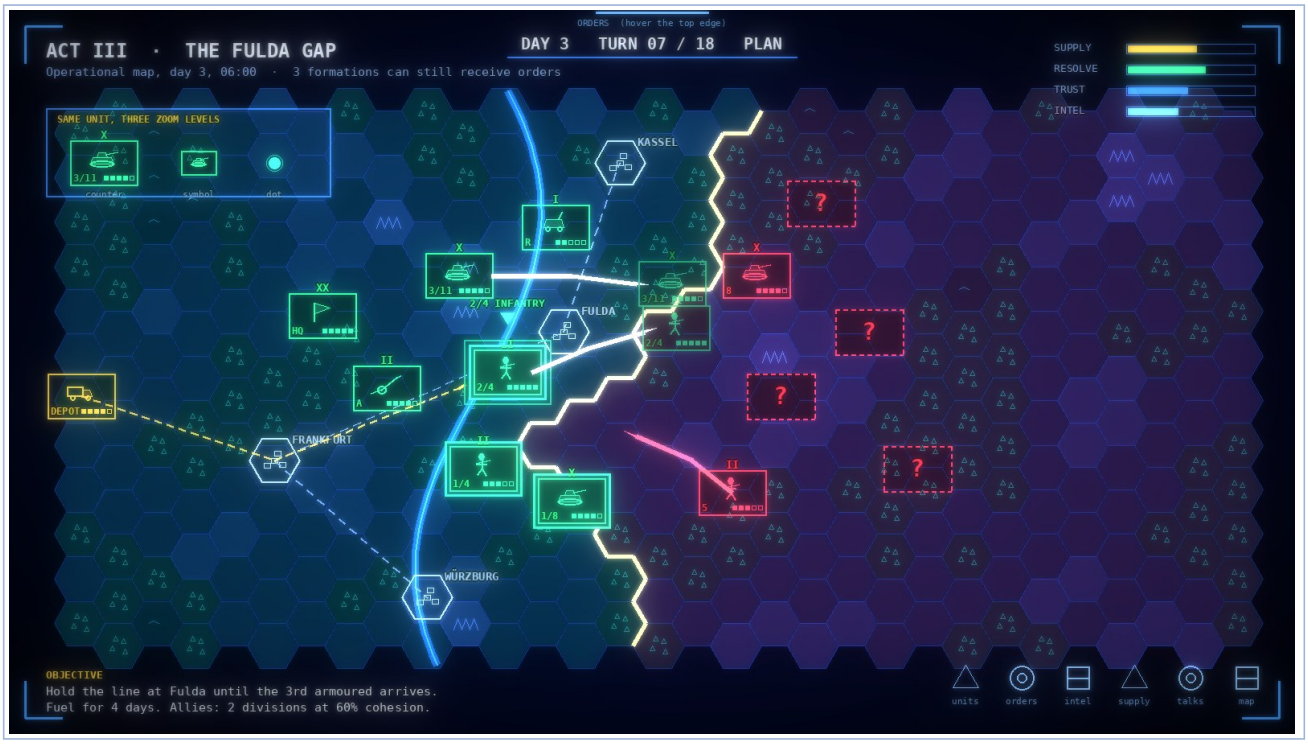
Close missions, painted. Vienna at night with the refined figures at scale: a door is a little taller than a person, a floor is two tiles of height, lamps are person-sized.



Vertical special operation. The roof agent has a halo and flag at roof height; heights follow the same scale rules.



Border patrol. Same style outdoors.



Act III, the Fulda Gap, with the new unit style. Counters with echelon marks and pips, a selected formation with a double frame and a name flag, previewed moves as ghost counters, '?' contacts, and an inset showing one unit at three zoom levels (counter, symbol, dot).



Act VI, the world, with the new unit style. Round glyphs for silos, subs, radar, carriers, bombers, fighters and satellites; the selected silo is ringed in green with a flag; red are opposing assets. The ark site is yellow.



Highlight language with the refined figures.

What is locked and what is open

- **Locked early:** the camera type per mission style, the scale rules above, the colour meanings, the unit family (figure, counter, symbol, dot), and the neon information layer on top.
- **Open to improvement later:** figure detail and animation, textures, lighting, effects and interface skin. Because rules and drawing are separate, they can improve without changing gameplay, as the current game has already shown twice.
- **Zoom:** counters become symbols and then dots as you zoom out; the same unit keeps its identity.

Questions

- Are the refined figures (volume, rim light, fixed scale) what you wanted? Any change in proportion or detail?
- Are the counter style and the round world glyphs right? Anything missing among the unit types?
- Should I now go back to Cold Synapse, or is there another sample you want first?